

Vladimirov turns 90

By C.G.S.Narayanan

In the August issue of Russian magazine '64-Chess review' Grandmaster Alexandr Kuzovkov wrote an excellent and exhaustive article on Russian composer Yacov G. Vladimirov, rightly considered one of the greats of chess composition who turned 90 on July 22. Kuzovkov writes "His first problem was published in 1955, and since then he has composed 820 compositions, many of which have been awarded prizes in various competitions. In the collections of the best problems in the world – FIDE Albums he has 232.5 points, which is one of the best results in the entire history of composition.

Vladimirov has received many chess awards and titles. He has been a grandmaster of the USSR since 1980 and an international grandmaster since 1986 for chess composition. He has been a world champion in composition in the individual category three times, won the title of world champion as part of the teams of the USSR and Russia eight times, and has won the USSR championship nine times. Vladimirov was an associate professor and lecturer at the Moscow Aviation Institute. He is a candidate of sciences and the author of many scientific works".

The first problem below is the famous Vladimirov theme which also contains a paradoxical plot and undoubtedly belongs to the golden era of chess composition. Looking at the position, one wants to somehow activate the white half-battery. We try 1.Nd6? ~ 2.Nf7#, 1... Nh6 2.Nc3#, 1...Nxd6 2.Bd4#. But this play is refuted by 1... Bg8! Let's try

to attack with another knight: 1.Nd4? ~ 2.Nc6#, 1...Nxd4 2.Bd6#, 1...Ne3 2.Qg3#, 1...Ne7 2.Nc3. And again, failure due to 1...Re3! And suddenly, absolutely unexpectedly, like thunder in a clear sky, 1.Be3! ~ 2.Bf4, 1... Rxe3 2.Qa5, 1... Nxe3 2.Qg3. The paradoxical plot: it turns out that to win, one must destroy the white half-battery!"

Y.G.Vladimirov
1 prize, Shakmati 1967



Mate in two moves

The problem for solving below again a non-standard plot. Await the main place of work of this great composer -the three-movers and more-movers in the next article

Y.G.Vladimirov
I prize, Moscow Ty 1987



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving by Kabe Moen in the article 'Combination of themes': 1.Nc4-d6! (2.Qf5) 1...Rxf4 2.Qxg8; 1...Qxf4 2.Nxf2; 1..Kxf4 2.Nxd2; 1...Ne5 2.Nf6; 1...Rg5 2.Qxg5; 1...Rf8 2.Qg5

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